Indonesian vice president's exit will widen Prabowo-Jokowi rift

送信者: EG Southeast Asia 受信日時: 2026-11-10 21:15

【メール原文】

Indonesian vice president's potential departure would deepen the growing political split between Prabowo and Jokowi, raising questions about coalition|||||||||||||||

Quick take
Customize Email Preferences

Indonesian vice president's exit will widen Prabowo-Jokowi rift

10 Nov 2026 07:13 EST Discover more on the Portal
Short-term trajectory:
Long-term trajectory:

What Happened

Vice President Gibran Rakabuming Raka—son of former president Joko Widodo (Jokowi)—has offered to resign; at the time of writing, it is unclear if President Prabowo Subianto has accepted. Earlier today, Gibran's parliamentary opponents initiated a constitutional process that would likely have resulted in his impeachment following a scandal over his education qualifications.

Our Take

Gibran's resignation worsens Prabowo-Jokowi split. Parliamentary pressure began to mount following the Constitutional Court decision on his educational qualifications. While the court did not rule Gibran ineligible for office, it said it could not find evidence that he holds a high school diploma or equivalent, as required under election law. Gibran's resignation comes amid escalating tensions between Prabowo and Jokowi, including the wiretapping scandal involving figures linked to the former president. In addition, three cabinet ministers quit Jokowi's Indonesian Solidarity Party (PSI) this week, likely to protect their jobs.

Gibran's departure is unlikely to threaten Prabowo's ability to govern. The president's wider coalition controls around 80% of parliamentary seats, while Gibran is not a party member and Jokowi's PSI has no seats. Indeed, the vice presidency could be used to bring the currently non-aligned Indonesian Democratic Party of Struggle (PDI-P) into the ruling coalition, effectively giving Prabowo full control of parliament. Contacts have shared mixed views on PDI-P's enthusiasm to join ranks with Prabowo.

The main risk would be a broader confrontation with Jokowi's remaining allies, particularly if tensions extend into other political and security institutions.

The separation could serve Jokowi's and Gibran's longer-term political interests ahead of the presidential election in 2029. Losing the vice presidency will distance Gibran from Prabowo, whose approval rating has dropped sharply (now at around 50%). Jokowi could similarly use the split to rebuild an independent political base through PSI and preserve his leverage ahead of the next election. However,

translating their personal networks and political influence into electoral support will be challenging, particularly given PSI's lack of parliamentary representation.

The implications for economic policymaking will likely be limited. Gibran has had little influence on the economic agenda, which remains driven by Prabowo and his team. However, prolonged infighting and potential further cabinet reshuffles as Prabowo distances himself from Jokowi-linked figures could distract the government from important economic priorities and reforms.

VP pick will test Prabowo's ability to consolidate power without destabilizing coalition. If a deal is struck with PDI-P, vice presidential options include Puan Maharani, speaker of the lower house, and Pramono Anung, governor of Jakarta. If PDI-P stays out of Prabowo's coalition, contenders include Agus Harimurti Yudhoyono, head of the Democrat Party, Bahlil Lahadalia, head of Golkar Party (but he may be affected by the wiretapping scandal), or a senior figure from Prabowo's Gerindra Party, such as Sufmi Dasco Ahmad or Sugiono. Appointing a Gerindra loyalist would reinforce Prabowo's control, while giving another party the role could either strengthen coalition unity or fuel internal competition. It is also conceivable that Prabowo picks a candidate who is amenable to Jokowi, to prevent the rift turning into full-blown political conflict.

Peter Mumford
Practice Head, Southeast Asia
+65 6653.4316
mumford@eurasiagroup.net
Olga Letticia
Associate, Southeast Asia
letticia.ne@eurasiagroup.net
EG Southeast Asia
southeastasia@eurasiagroup.net
Now on iOS and Android
Get the Eurasia Group app
Read anywhere · Receive notifications · Reach out to analysts
App Store
Google Play

© 2026 Eurasia Group. All rights reserved. This material was produced by Eurasia Group for use by the recipient. This is intended as general background research and is not intended to constitute advice on any particular commercial investment or trade matter or issue and should not be relied upon for such purposes. It is not to be made available to any person other than the recipient. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or otherwise, without the prior consent of Eurasia Group.
X-HG-DocID cmwal2xtp6rvh07n4pbcbqf38

Opt Out | Customize Email Preferences